

Vibe Coding Kills Open Source

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“I ship code I don’t read.”

Peter Steinberger, OpenClaw (2026)



“70-80-90% of code at Anthropic is written by Claude.”

Dario Amodei, Axios AI+ Summit (2025) ## What is “vibe coding”?

- User describes intent, gets working software
- AI agent selects and assembles open source packages
- **User never reads docs, files bugs, or engages with maintainers**

The puzzle

OSS usage ↑

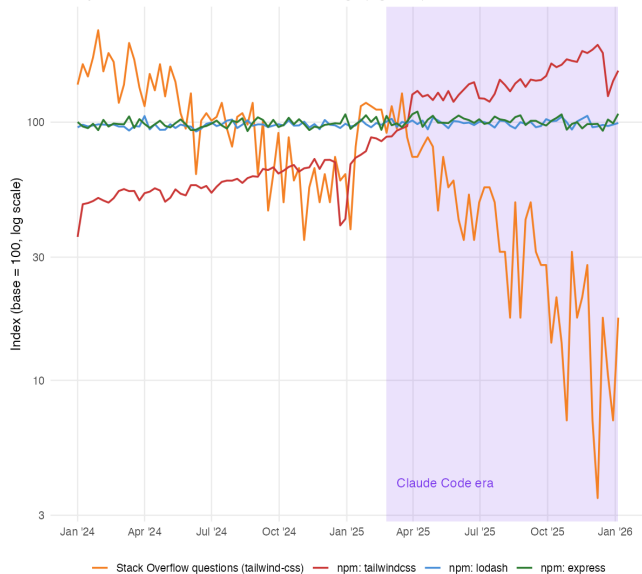
OSS engagement ↓

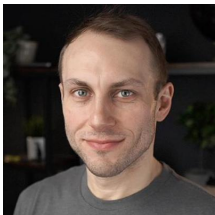
How can both be true?

Tailwind CSS: A case study

Tailwind CSS: Usage vs Human Support Requests

Weekly data, indexed to 100 = March 2025 average (log scale)





“Traffic to our docs is down 40% despite Tailwind being more popular than ever. Revenue is down close to 80%.”

Adam Wathan, Tailwind CSS creator (2026)

Two channels

Productivity

AI lowers cost of building OSS

Demand diversion

Users don't engage, maintainers lose
visibility

How OSS maintainers earn returns

- Documentation visits → consulting leads
- Bug reports → reputation → job offers
- Stars/downloads → sponsorships

All require direct engagement

A model of the OSS ecosystem

- Developers create packages, decide whether to share
- Users choose packages, choose how to use them
- Vibe coding: higher productivity, lower engagement

$$\pi = \bar{\pi}(1 - v)$$

Revenue falls with vibe coding share v

Which channel wins?

Demand diversion is about 6x as big as productivity gains

Long-run equilibrium

- Entry falls → fewer new packages
- Variety shrinks → less choice
- Quality declines → worse software

Welfare can fall despite better AI

The magnification trap

The same feedback loop that grew OSS...

more entry → better ecosystem → lower costs → more entry

... now works in reverse

less entry → worse ecosystem → higher costs → less entry

What would save OSS?

84%

of revenue must come from visibility independent sources

A Spotify model for OSS

- AI platforms already track which packages they use
- Revenue sharing based on attributable usage
- Infrastructure for redistribution exists

Takeaway

Vibe coding is a **fundamental shift** in how software is produced and consumed.

The productivity gains are real. So is the threat to OSS.

koren.mk

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Appendix

Stack Overflow is dying

